

'Tis a gift to be simple

Text: Joseph Bracket, 1848

Music: Joseph Bracket, 1848

SIMPLE GIFTS irregular

arr. Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021



The musical score is written for voice and piano in 4/4 time, featuring a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody is primarily in the treble clef, while the piano accompaniment is in the bass clef. The score is divided into four systems, each with a vocal line and a piano line. Chord symbols (I, V, ii⁷, vi, IV) are placed above the vocal line to indicate the harmonic structure. The lyrics are written below the vocal line, with some words hyphenated across measures. The piano accompaniment consists of chords and moving lines in the bass clef, providing a harmonic foundation for the vocal melody.

I V ii⁷ V

'Tis a gift to be sim-ple, 'tis a gift to be free, 'tis a gift to come down where we ought to be.

I vi ii⁷ vi V IV I

And when we find our-selves in the place just right 'twill be in the val-ley of love and de-light.

I vi V vi V I V

When true sim - pli - ci - ty is gained, to bow and to bend we will not be a-shamed;

I V vi ii⁷ vi V IV I

to turn, turn, will be our de-light, till by turn - ing, turn-ing we come round right.